

Word family: **story / stories / storytelling / storyteller / storybook**

Base word: story

Plural: stories

Related forms: storytelling, storyteller, storybook

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related noun forms (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “What I admire most is that he can take a small, everyday scene and turn it into a **story** with texture, humour, and meaning.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **story** means an **account or narrative created from events, observations, people, and details, arranged so that they become engaging and meaningful to a listener**.

Mr. Wong can take something ordinary from daily life and shape it into an interesting narrative.

繁體中文： **把人物、事件、觀察和細節有次序地組織起來，形成一段能讓人理解、想像或投入其中的敘述**

中文翻譯：

> “...turn it into a **story** with texture, humour, and meaning.”

「.....把它說成一個有質感、有幽默感、也有意義的**故事 / 敘述**。」

Here:

story = 把人物、事件和細節組織成一段完整而有吸引力的敘述

1. **story = narrative about events/characters (敘事作品) — 故事**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: An account or narrative involving events, people, or characters, told or written in a connected way.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can take a small, everyday scene and turn it into a **story**.”

「他可以把一個日常小場面變成一個**故事**。」

Practice 2

> “She told us a funny **story** about her childhood.”

「她跟我們講了一個關於童年的有趣**故事**。」

Practice 3

> “The book contains several short **stories**.”

「這本書收錄了幾個短篇**故事**。」

story = 把人物、事件或經歷按照某種次序連接起來形成的敘述

A story may be:

- * true;
- * partly true;
- * fictional.

The word itself does not automatically tell us whether it is factual or invented.

2. **story** = account of something that really happened (真實經歷 / 事情經過) — 經歷 ; 事情經過 ; 敘述

Story can refer specifically to someone's account of real events.

Practice 4

> “She told the police her **story**.”

「她向警方講述了事情的**經過** / 自己的說法。」

Practice 5

> “His **story** of growing up in the city was fascinating.”

「他講述自己在這座城市成長的**經歷**非常吸引。」

story = 對真實發生過的事情、個人經歷或事件經過所作的敘述

This overlaps strongly with Meaning 1, but it is useful to show because learners sometimes assume:

> **story = fictional tale only**

That is incorrect.

For core counting, I would usually **merge this with #1**, because the broader concept remains:

> **a connected narrative of events**

The factual status changes, not the core narrative meaning.

3. **story = news report (新聞報道) — 新聞 ; 報道**

In journalism and media, a **story** can mean a particular news report or item.

Practice 6

> “The newspaper published a **story** about the housing problem.”

「報紙刊登了一篇有關房屋問題的**新聞報道**。」

Practice 7

> “The reporter is working on a **story** about public transport.”

「那名記者正在採訪一篇關於公共交通的**新聞報道**。」

story = 新聞媒體就某個事件、人物或議題製作的一篇 / 一則報道

Common:

- * news story
- * cover a story
- * break a story
- * work on a story

This is particularly relevant to your passage because Mr. Wong is a retired journalist.

I would keep this as a distinct practical sense because in media English:

> “I’m working on a story.”

does not normally mean:

> “I’m writing fiction.”

4. **story** = version/account given by someone (說法) — 說法 ; 版本

A **story** can mean the particular version of events that someone gives.

Practice 8

> “His **story** changed several times during the interview.”

「他在訪問期間的**說法**改了好幾次。」

Practice 9

> “Their **stories** do not match.”

「他們兩人的**說法 / 版本**對不上。」

someone's story = 某人對事情如何發生所提供的說法或版本

This is a distinct learner concept from a general narrative because the focus is:

> **one person's account of disputed or uncertain events**

It is common in:

- * police investigations;
- * disagreements;
- * journalism;
- * legal contexts.

5. **story** = explanation behind a situation (背景 / 來龍去脈) — 背後故事 ; 事情原委

Story can refer to the broader explanation of how a present situation developed.

Practice 10

> “What’s the **story** behind this old building?”

「這座舊建築背後有甚麼**故事 / 來歷**？」

Practice 11

> “The numbers only make sense when you understand the full **story**.”

「只有了解事情完整的**背景和來龍去脈**，這些數字才有意義。」

story = 解釋某件事情如何形成、為甚麼會這樣，以及背後相關事件的整體脈絡

For database counting, I would connect this closely to Meaning 2/4 rather than inflate the count unnecessarily, but it is a useful practical subtype.

6. **story** = lie / invented explanation (假話 / 捏造說法) — 謊話；編造的故事

In some contexts, especially informal ones, **story** can imply that an explanation is invented or untrue.

Practice 12

> “Do you really believe that **story**?”

「你真的相信那個**說法 / 那套故事**嗎？」

Practice 13

> “He made up a **story** about missing the train.”

「他編了一個**藉口 / 假故事**，說自己錯過了火車。」

story = 為了解釋或掩飾某件事而編造、不一定真實的說法

Important:

story does not inherently mean lie.

The dishonest meaning comes from context, especially with expressions such as:

- * make up a story
- * invent a story
- * don't believe his story

So I would keep it as a contextual figurative sense, not assume every **story** is fictional or false.

7. **story** = plot/narrative content of a film/book/game (作品情節) — 故事情節；劇情

In entertainment, **story** can mean the events and narrative content of a larger work.

Practice 14

> “The film has a simple **story**, but the characters are excellent.”

「這部電影的**故事情節**很簡單，但人物塑造非常出色。」

Practice 15

> “I enjoyed the game, but the **story** was difficult to follow.”

「我喜歡這款遊戲，但它的**劇情 / 故事線**很難跟上。」

story = 電影、小說、遊戲等作品中所發生的主要事件和敘事內容

For core counting, I would usually merge this with the basic **narrative** sense in #1.

The medium changes, but the semantic concept remains the same.

8. **story** = floor/level of a building (建築物樓層) — 樓層

There is also a completely different noun **story**, especially in American English:

> **story** = storey

meaning one level of a building.

Practice 16

> “They live in a ten-**story** building.”

「他們住在一棟十**層**高的大樓裡。」

Practice 17

> “The office occupies the top **story**.”

「辦公室位於最頂**層**。」

story = 建築物由一層地板至上一層地板之間的一個樓層；美式拼法

Regional note

****American English:**** story

****British English:**** storey

This is genuinely unrelated to narrative ****story**** and clearly deserves a separate meaning.

Related form: ****storytelling****

****Storytelling**** means the activity or skill of telling stories effectively.

Practice 18

> “He has a natural talent for ****storytelling****.”

「他天生很有****說故事 / 敘事****的才能。」

Practice 19

> “Good ****storytelling**** can make ordinary events memorable.”

「出色的****敘事技巧****可以令普通事件變得令人難忘。」

****storytelling = 把人物、事件和細節組織成吸引人的故事並向別人表達的活動或技巧****

This is highly relevant to your original passage.

Related form: ****storyteller****

A ****storyteller**** is someone who tells or creates stories.

Practice 20

> “He is an excellent ****storyteller****.”

「他是一位很出色的****說故事者 / 敘事高手****。」

Practice 21

> “The best ****storytellers**** know how to make small details matter.”

「最好的****說故事者****知道如何令小細節變得重要。」

****storyteller = 擅長用口頭、文字或其他形式講述故事的人****

Related form: ****storybook****

****Storybook**** means a book containing stories, especially for children.

Practice 22

> “She bought a ****storybook**** for her daughter.”

「她給女兒買了一本****故事書****。」

Practice 23

> “The village looks like something from a ****storybook****.”

「這條村看起來就像****童話故事書****裡的地方。」

The second use can become figurative:

> ****storybook village****

= 美得像故事書 / 童話中的村落

This is a useful family extension, not another core meaning of bare ****story****.

Fixed expression: ****long story short — 長話短說****

Practice 24

> “****Long story short****, we missed the last train.”

「****長話短說****，我們錯過了最後一班火車。」

Practice 25

> “To make a ****long story short****, the plan failed.”

「****簡單來說 / 長話短說****，這個計劃失敗了。」

****long story short = 省略很多細節，只說事情最後最重要的部分****

This is a common fixed expression.

Fixed expression: ****the whole story — 全部真相 / 完整經過****

Practice 26

> “I don’t think we know the ****whole story**** yet.”

「我覺得我們仍未知道事情的****全部真相 / 完整經過****。」

Practice 27

> “She finally told me the ****whole story****.”

「她終於把事情的****完整經過****告訴了我。」

****the whole story = 有關某件事情的完整事實、背景和經過****

This develops from the ****account/version**** sense.

Fixed expression: ****that's another story — 那是另一回事****

Practice 28

> “Getting the job was easy; keeping it was ****another story****.”

「得到那份工作很容易，但能不能保住它就是****另一回事****了。」

Practice 29

> “The plan sounds good. Whether it will work is ****another story****.”

「這個計劃聽起來不錯，但是否真的行得通就是****另一回事****。」

****another story = 另一個不同而通常更複雜的問題 / 情況****

This is idiomatic and should stay outside the core count.

Important distinction: ****story vs history****

This is especially relevant because **history** appeared earlier in the passage.

story

= an account or narrative; it may be true or fictional.

history

= actual past events, or the study/record of them.

> “the story of Hong Kong”

may be a narrative about Hong Kong.

> “the history of Hong Kong”

specifically concerns Hong Kong's actual historical development.

So:

story = 敘述 / 故事

history = 真實過去的發展 / 歷史學

Important distinction: **story** vs **account**

story

is broad and often emphasizes narrative structure and engaging presentation.

account

often emphasizes a factual description or report of what happened.

> “She told an amazing story about the accident.”

can sound narrative.

> “She gave the police an account of the accident.”

sounds more factual/formal.

They overlap, but their usual register and focus differ.

Important distinction: **story vs tale**

story

is the neutral general word.

tale

often sounds more literary, traditional, imaginative, or deliberately narrative.

> fairy tale

> folk tale

So **story** is broader and more everyday.

Important distinction: **story vs plot**

story

= the events and narrative content overall

plot

= how those events are deliberately arranged and connected within a work

A movie can have:

> a simple story

but:

> a complicated plot

because the underlying events may be simple while their presentation is structurally complex.

Important distinction: **story vs news**

news

is the broader uncountable category:

> “I heard some news.”

a story

in journalism is one individual report:

> “I read a story about the election.”

So:

****news = 新聞資訊整體****

****news story = 一則具體新聞報道****

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **story**

* **stories**

* **storytelling**

* **storyteller**

* **storybook**

Useful expressions include:

* tell a story

* news story

* life story

* the whole story

* long story short

* another story

* story behind something

The Golden Manual says useful compounds and family extensions should be included when they add real learning value, but should not be mislabeled as separate meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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| **story — narrative** | 把人物、事件或經歷按照某種次序連接起來形成的一段敘述，可是真實或虛構 |

| **story — real-life account** | 對真實發生過的事情、個人經歷或事件經過所作的敘述；屬於一般 narrative 義 |

| **story — news report** | 新聞媒體就某個事件、人物或議題製作的一篇 / 一則報道 |

| **someone's story — version/account** | 某人對事情如何發生所提供的說法或版本 |

| **story — background/what happened** | 解釋某件事情如何形成、為甚麼如此以及背後事件的整體來龍去脈 |

| **story — invented excuse/lie** | 在特定語境中指為解釋或掩飾事情而編造、不一定真實的說法 |

| **story — plot/narrative content** | 電影、小說、遊戲等作品中所發生的主要事件和敘事內容；屬於 narrative 義 |

| **story — building level, AmE** | 建築物的一個樓層；美式英語，相當於英式英語 storey |

| **storytelling** | 把人物、事件和細節組織成吸引人的故事並有效表達的活動或技巧 |

| **storyteller** | 擅長用口頭、文字或其他形式講述故事的人 |

For your original sentence

> “...turn it into a **story** with texture, humour, and meaning.”

The exact meaning is:

story = 把人物、事件、觀察和細節有組織地連接起來，形成一段完整、吸引人的敘述

More specifically:

turn an everyday scene into a story = 把原本普通的日常場面重新組織和講述，使它變成有情節、有細節、有趣味和意義的敘事

So:

> **a story with texture, humour, and meaning**

= **一個有層次、有幽默感而且有深層意義的故事 / 敘述**

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **story**:

1. **narrative/account of events, real or fictional**
2. **journalism — an individual news report**
3. **someone's version/account of disputed or uncertain events**
4. **building level — American English story = British English storey**

I would merge **film story / life story / true story / fictional story** under #1, and treat **story behind something, the whole story, long story short,** and **another story** as useful fixed or contextual extensions rather than inflate the core count.